

BUILDING RESILIENT HEALTHCARE SYSTEMS THROUGH AI-POWERED BUSINESS CONTINUITY MANAGEMENT

Co-Authors:

Social Equation Hub - Maksim Demchenko & Giorgi Soselia

The Global Fund - Andreas Tamberg

Abilene Group - Henri Haenni



WHAT IS BUSINESS CONTINUITY MANAGEMENT

Holistic management process that identifies potential threats to an organization and the impacts to business operations those threats, might cause, and which provides a framework for building organizational resilience with the capability of an effective response. (International Glossary for Resiliency)

THE PROBLEM - WHEN HEALTH SYSTEMS BREAK DOWN

Crises are inevitable - epidemics, cyberattacks, wars, or supply disruptions.

60–80% of unprepared organizations **fail** after major disruption

In HIV and public health programs:

- Treatment interruptions
- Supply disruptions
- Collapse of services
- Staff burnout

Key Message: Health systems can't afford downtime. Continuity saves lives!

TWO PATHS IN CRISES

WITHOUT PREPAREDNESS

- ✗ No clear plan
- ✗ Confusion and delays
- ✗ Services disrupted
- ✗ Long, costly recovery
- ✗ Organization weakened

WITH BCM & ISO 22301

- ✓ Plan activated immediately
- ✓ Trained response teams
- ✓ Critical care continues
- ✓ Rapid recovery
- ✓ Organization strengthened

Crises are inevitable. The question is not IF, but WHEN - and whether your organization will be ready.

WHAT BUSINESS CONTINUITY MANAGEMENT (BCM) SOLVES

BCM = Systematic preparation for uncertainty

Challenge	BCM Solution
Chaotic crisis response	Predefined, tested procedures
Service interruption	Rapid recovery and alternate workflows
Dependency on key staff	Knowledge embedded in systems
Fragmented communication	Clear crisis command structure
Compliance & trust	ISO 22301 framework proof

ISO 22301 = International standard ensuring **preparedness, control, and rapid recovery** across health and humanitarian sectors

The Cycle of Resilience

PLAN

Identify critical services (HIV treatment, labs, logistics)

DO

Build, train, and test continuity plans

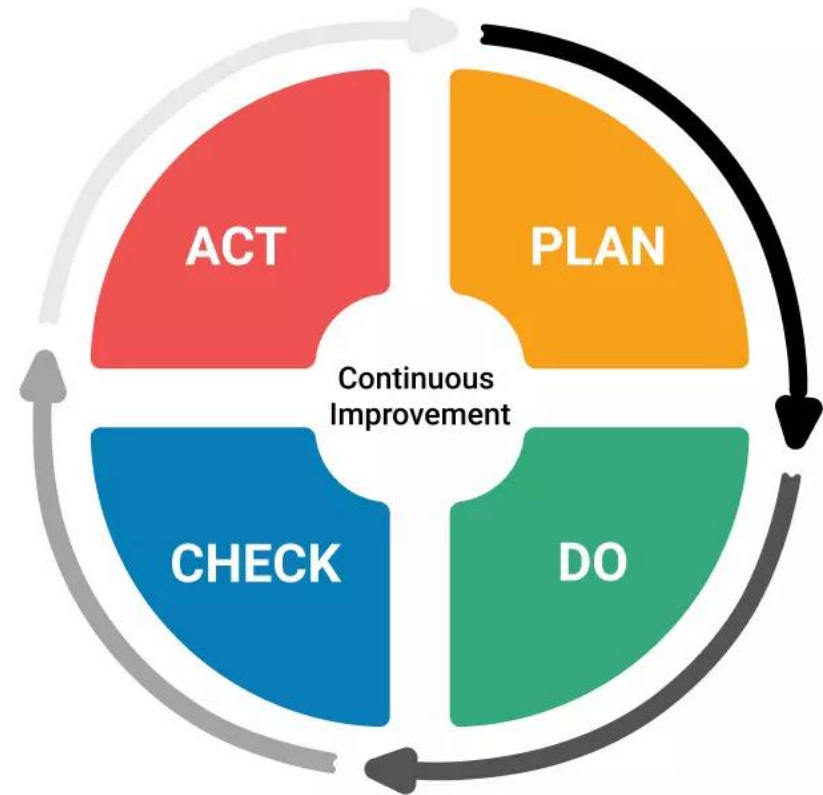
CHECK

Evaluate and simulate real disruptions

ACT

Improve based on lessons learned

Continuous improvement = “Living immune system” of organization



THE PROBLEM: INEQUALITY OF PREPAREDNESS

Traditional BCM implementation following ISO 22301 standards is proven and effective, but creates massive barriers to access

Case Study: Primary Health Centre (Ukraine)

Traditional Implementation Costs (24 months):

- External consultants: €60,000
- Staff training & workshops: €20,000
- Documentation development: €15,000
- Audits & certification: €12,000
- Ongoing support: €10,000
- **TOTAL: €117,000 over 2 years**

Barriers Created:

- High cost (€100K-150K) accessible only to well-funded organizations
- Long timeline (2+ years) delays protection
- Specialized expertise required, not widely available
- Not scalable to smaller organizations or resource-limited settings
- Knowledge remains with external consultants, not internalized

Result: Large hospitals can afford preparedness. Small clinics, rural health centers, and vulnerable communities cannot. This creates fundamental healthcare equity problem.

WHY AI CHANGES EVERYTHING

AI-Based BCM Enables:

- Automated Business Impact Analysis (BIA) within hours
- Predictive risk modeling (before crisis escalates)
- Intelligent incident response support
- Continuous learning from global crisis data
- Democratized access to expertise for small NGOs and clinics

Shift:

- From static → adaptive
- From reactive → predictive
- From expert-limited → accessible to all.

Artificial Intelligence democratizes access to world-class BCM expertise, making systematic preparedness accessible to healthcare organizations of any size or budget.

THE AI- ENABLED CONTINUITY PLATFORM

CORE PLATFORM COMPONENTS

1. **AI-Assisted BIA Service** - maps critical processes, dependencies, and risk exposure
2. **AI Risk Service** - predicts disruption likelihood and financial/operational impact
3. **Continuity Plan Generator** - produces ISO 22301-aligned plans in minutes
4. **Incident Copilot** - provides real-time decision support during crises
5. **Learning Engine** - analyzes incidents globally to update best practices

How It Works

AI-Guided Implementation:

1. ASSESSMENT

- AI conversational agent guides Business Impact Analysis (BIA)
- Identifies critical services, dependencies, risks, and priorities
- Adaptive questioning tailored to organization's specific context

2. PLANNING

- Platform builds customized BCM plans using ISO 22301 framework
- Response procedures, recovery strategies, communication protocols
- Templates adapted to organization's reality, not one-size-fits-all

3. IMPLEMENTATION

- Table-top exercises and scenario-based training
- Staff capacity building through interactive learning
- Plan testing, refinement, and certification preparation

THE AI-ENABLED CONTINUITY PLATFORM IS POWER BY:

Integrated ISO 22301, WHO, and NIST frameworks



Key Principles

Conversational: Natural language interaction, adaptive questioning

Contextual: Understands healthcare domain, adapts to specific organizations

Learning: Improves from collective experience across implementations

Privacy-Preserving: Federated learning protects sensitive organizational data

Human-Centered: Supports professionals, builds organizational capacity

WHO BENEFITS?

Any healthcare organization serving communities that depend on continuous, reliable service:

Hospitals: Large and small, specialized and general care

Laboratories: Diagnostic facilities, research institutions, public health labs

Public Health Centers: Community clinics, disease surveillance, mobile health units

Health Ministries: National coordination, policy, emergency response

NGOs & Humanitarian Organizations: Field operations, vulnerable populations, crisis response

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN PRACTICE

Scenario: HIV service disruption due to cyberattack

Without AI-BCM:

- IT systems locked → patient data inaccessible
- 3–7 days of service disruption
- ART adherence drops → health risk, funding loss

With AI-BCM:

- AI detects anomaly → triggers incident workflow
- Switches to offline protocols automatically
- AI advises recovery sequence
- 8-hour downtime → full restoration
- Lessons learned fed back into global knowledge base

Scenario: Regional ART supply chain disruption due to border closure.

AI-Driven Actions:

1. **BIA Service (Healthcare Mode)** auto-detects dependency on cross-border logistics and predicts stock-out risk.
2. **Risk Service** runs Risk Scenario Analysis for “supply chain disruption” and quantifies impact on ART continuity.
3. **Planning Service** generates a Recovery Plan with alternative suppliers and adjusted delivery schedules.
4. **Compliance Module** records all actions as ISO 22301 evidence package.

Outcome:

- Service continuity preserved (zero treatment interruption).
- Dynamic dashboards updated in real time.
- Lessons automatically integrated into collective learning base.

WHY AI-BASED BCM MATTERS FOR HIV RESPONSE

- Health service continuity = **lives saved**
- Ensures **ART delivery** and **data protection**
- Prevents **human error** and **operational paralysis**
- Builds donor confidence through **verifiable resilience**
- Aligns with **WHO Health System Strengthening** and **ISO 22301** principles

Resilient Health = Sustainable Health

Unified environment for AI-assisted planning, crisis management, and reporting.

AI Foundation: Agents for Risk, BIA, Compliance

Collective Intelligence: Shared learning between NGOs, ministries, and hospitals

Community Intelligence: Feedback and validation from field partners

Blockchain Integration: Immutable continuity audit trail + Proof-of-Preparedness

THE PLATFORM ECOSYSTEM

IMPACT & MEASURABLE BENEFITS

- 80% reduction in plan development time
- 50–70% faster recovery times
- 3× higher readiness levels
- Transparent proof of resilience for funders & regulators



THANK YOU!